

Solomon's Wisdom and Downfall

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Written by Daniel Tesfamariam

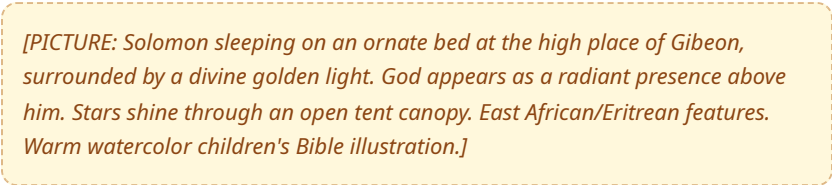
Ages 10-17

Little Believers Tigrinya Bible Stories

Book 56 of 60

neti ziHayele'wn aykonenn, ginakhe neti Amlak zimezezo — ab zifan kiqmeT meriTswō. Dawit neti ziterefo Hayili akibu nSelomon bihTsuTs tezarebo, "TsinaE sebay din kun. Nay Igzi'abher Amlakka Halawa Halu, ab mengeditatu bimimllas, Higagatun ti'izazatun bimHlaw." Izi nay limdi qalat Teray ayneberen; nay abo zitemene limena iyu neyru, nay hade abo kibrin 'inwetn mis Amlak mikwadn mi'inqafn zifeleTe. Selomon neti zewdi bizinqeTqeTa a'idaw teqebelo, mengisti Teray zeyikone nay kidan rikib mis hiyaw Amlak kemi ziweris zifeliT.)

Scene 2 of 25



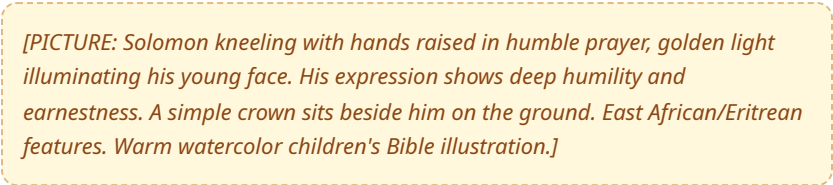
At Gibeon, the greatest high place in Israel, Solomon offered a thousand burnt offerings upon the altar. That night, God appeared to Solomon in a dream — not as a distant deity, but as a personal God who speaks directly to His children. The Lord said simply and profoundly: "Ask what I shall give you." Consider the weight of this moment: the Creator of the universe, the God who spoke stars into existence, was offering a blank check to a young king. This was not a test of cleverness but a revelation of character. What a person asks for when they can have anything reveals who they truly are at their core. Solomon stood at the crossroads where every human stands — the choice between what we want and what we need, between immediate gratification and eternal purpose.

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(Ab Gib'on, iti zi'abeye berikH bota ab Isra'el, Selomon shiH zibeE meswa'iti ab mesew'i aqrebe. Beta leyti Amlak nSelomon biHilmi tera'iyō — kemi riHuq Amlak zeyikone, kemi wilqawi Amlak biqeTta ndequ zizareb. Igzi'abher biqelilun bi'amiquun

"intay kihbeka Hitet" bele. Nayzi himot kibdet Hiseb, iti feTari 'alem, iti kewakhbti biqalu zifeTere Amlak, nHade men'esey nigus kifut 'idil yihbo nebere. Izi nay bilHinet fetena zeyikone nay bahriy miglaTsi iyu neyru. Hade seb zikone kirekib kelo intay kemi ziHatit biHaqi men mik'anu yigelTs. Selomon abti kulu seb ziqewmelu mengedi godena dew ilu — ab mengo zideliyon zedliyon, ab mengo gizeyawi 'igbetn zel'alemawi 'ilaman mircha.)

Scene 3 of 25



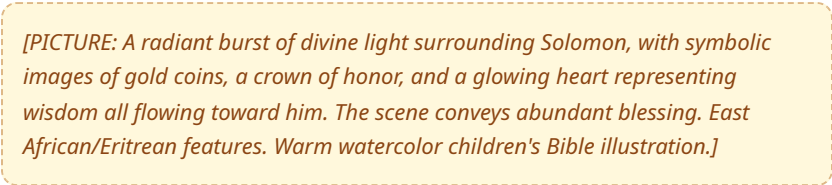
Solomon's response revealed a heart that had not yet been corrupted by power. He said, "I am but a little child; I do not know how to go out or come in. Give your servant an understanding heart to judge your people, that I may discern between good and evil." Notice what he did not ask for: he did not ask for the death of his enemies, for wealth that would make him untouchable, or for years of life to enjoy his power. Instead, he acknowledged his weakness — calling himself a child despite being king — and asked for the one thing that would benefit not himself but his people. This prayer was born from genuine humility, from a young man who understood that leadership is not about privilege but about responsibility. Solomon recognized that without divine wisdom, he would be nothing more than a boy playing king.

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(Melsi Selomon bisilTan zeytbelaShwe libi geleTse. "Ane ni'ishto qol'a iye; miwTs'an mi'itan ayfelTin. Nibaryakha nihizbkha kiferid ab mengo Tsibuqn kifu'en kifleli zikhi'il

*a'imro libi habeni" bele. Intay kemi zeyHatete astebhil, mot Tsela'itu ayHateten,
zeytitinkef zigebro habti ayHateten, silTanu zistmaqrelu 'ametat hiywetwn ayHateten.
Ab kinday dikhmetu aflete — nigus kinesu ri'isu qol'a bimbab — nri'isu zeyikone
nihizbu ziTeqim neger Hatete. Izi Tselot kab Haqenya tiHtina zitewelde iyu, kab hade
men'esey meraHnet biza'iba mesel zeyikone biza'iba Halafinet mik'anu ziterde'o.
Solomon bizey melekotawi Tibeb nigsina ziTsawet qol'a Teray mik'anu tegenzibu.)*

Scene 4 of 25



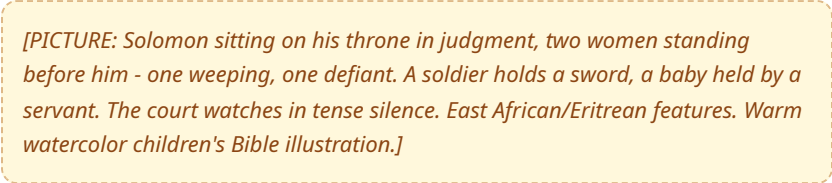
God's response overflowed with generosity. "Because you have asked this thing, and have not asked for yourself long life, nor riches, nor the life of your enemies, but have asked for understanding to discern justice — behold, I have done according to your words. I have given you a wise and understanding heart, so that there has been none like you before, nor shall any like you arise after you." But God did not stop there. He added what Solomon had not requested: "I have also given you what you have not asked — both riches and honor — so that there shall not be any among the kings like you all your days." This is the divine principle: when we seek God's purposes first, He provides everything else abundantly. Yet hidden within this blessing was a conditional warning that Solomon would one day forget.

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(Melsi Amlak bilewahnet fesese. "Izi neger sile ziHatetka, nri'iskha newikH 'idme zeyHatetka, habtiwn zeyHatetka, hiyewet Tsela'itkha'wn zeyHatetka, ginakhe fitHi

kitifeli mistew'al ziHatetka — inho kemi qalka geyrelka alekhu. Tibebenyan astew'aln libi hibeka alekhu, qidmekha kemakha zibele zeynebere diHrekha'wn kemakha zibele zeytins'i." Amlak ab'u gin ayequwareTsen. Selomon zeyHateto wesekehe, "zeyHatetkayo'wn hibeka alekhu — habtin kibrin — kulu me'altkha ab ma'ikel negestat kemakha zibele zeyhilu." Izi melekotawi metikel iyu, 'ilama Amlak qidmi mis indeli, kulu kal'e bibizHi yihibena. Ginakhe ab wishTi izi bereket Selomon hade me'alti zirs'o nay qidme kunet meTenqeqta teHabi'u neyru.)

Scene 5 of 25



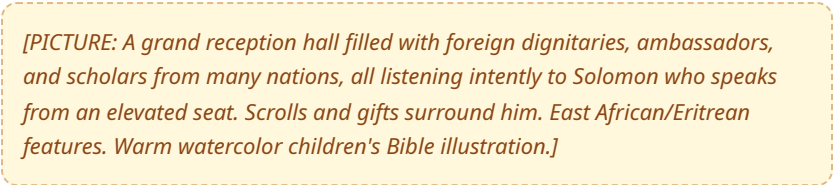
The first great demonstration of Solomon's wisdom came through a case that seemed impossible to solve. Two women lived in the same house, both had given birth within days of each other. One baby died in the night, and both women claimed the surviving child as their own. There were no witnesses, no evidence, no way to determine truth through ordinary means. Solomon commanded, "Bring me a sword. Divide the living child in two, and give half to one and half to the other." The real mother, her love overpowering her claim, cried out: "Give her the living child! Do not kill him!" But the other woman said coldly, "Let him be neither mine nor yours — divide him." Solomon knew immediately. The woman willing to lose her child to save his life was the true mother. Love reveals itself through sacrifice, not possession. All Israel heard of this judgment and stood in awe, for they saw that divine wisdom was in their king.

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(Iti qedamay 'abiy mir'it Tibeb Selomon bizey fitaH zimesil guday meTse. Kilde ansti ab hade geza yinebra neyren, kilti'en ab wishTi Hidet me'altat welidin. Hade HiTsan bileyti mote, kilti'en neti hiyaw qol'a natey iyu bela. Miskir ayneberen, mert'o ayneberen, binbur mengedi Haqi kitfelT zike'al ayneberen. Selomon "seyfi amTs'uley. Neti hiyaw qol'a bikilte miqraTsi fereqa nHanti fereqa dima neta Hanti habu" azeze. Ita Haqenya ade, fiqra kab kisara zi'ablele, "neti hiyaw qol'a ni'a habwa! Aytiqtelwo!" ila chederet. Ita khal'ayti gin biziHul "natey'wn natki'wn aykhun — miqraTswa" belet. Selomon bi'u nib'u feleTe. Ita hiyewetu kitidHin wilada kitsi'in dilwiti zineberet iya Haqenya ade. Fiqri bimeswa'iti yigleTsi biwunni aykonenn. Kula Isra'el nezi firdi semi'a bifirhi deneTset, melekotawi Tibeb ab nigusom kemi zelo sile zira'ayet.)

Scene 6 of 25



Word of Solomon's extraordinary wisdom spread like fire across the ancient world. Kings from distant lands sent ambassadors to hear him speak. Scholars traveled months across deserts and seas to sit at his feet and listen. Solomon could discourse on botany — from the great cedar of Lebanon to the hyssop growing from a wall. He understood zoology, speaking of animals, birds, reptiles, and fish with insight that amazed the learned men of Egypt and Babylon. His wisdom was not merely academic; it was practical, penetrating to the heart of human relationships, governance, justice, and the meaning of life itself. People brought their most complex disputes, their impossible questions, and Solomon untangled them with an ease that seemed supernatural. The young king had become the intellectual center of the known world, a living testament to what happens when God's gift meets a willing heart.

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(Zena fluy Tibebe Selomon kemi Hawi ab Tintawi 'alem tezergiHe. Negestat kab riHuq hageratat kistem'iwo li'ukhat sededu. Mihurat ni'awarH ab midre bedan baHrtatn tegu'izo ab igru kof ilom kismi'u meTsu. Selomon biza'iba tekhli kizareb yikh'il nebere — kab 'abiy om Libanos kisab ab ginbi zibequl hisopos. Biza'iba inisa, a'iwaf, lememe ziblun 'asan nimhurat GibTsin Babilonin zidenq biHtawi rid'it yizareb nebere. Tibebeu nay timhirti Teray ayneberen — gibrawi nebere, nab libi seb'awi rikbat, mimHidar, fitHin tirigum hiywetn zi'atu. Sebat zikebedu kirkratomn zeyki'al HiTotatomn amTsi'om Selomon bil'ili tefeTro zimesil qilTafe yifetHom nebere. Iti men'ese y nigus nay zifleT 'alem a'imroawi ma'ikel kone, hiyaw miskir wihbet Amlak diluw libi mis zirekib intay kemi zikhewn.)

Scene 7 of 25

[PICTURE: Thousands of workers quarrying massive stone blocks, cutting cedar logs, and hauling materials. Solomon reviews architectural plans with master craftsmen. The hillside of Jerusalem buzzes with organized labor. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

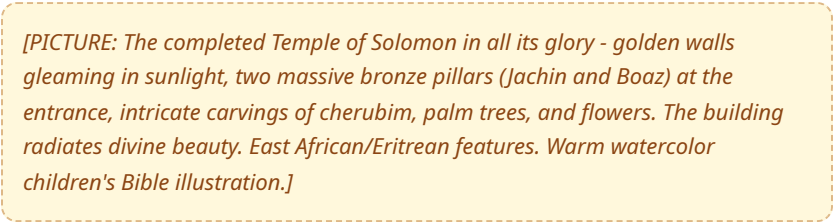
Solomon's greatest earthly project was the one his father David had dreamed of but was forbidden to build — a permanent house for the Lord God of Israel. The scale was staggering: 30,000 laborers worked in shifts in Lebanon cutting cedar, 80,000 quarried stone in the hill country, 70,000 carried burdens, and 3,300 officials supervised the work. Solomon sent word to King Hiram of Tyre, saying, "I intend to build a house for the name of the Lord my God." The finest cedar and cypress from Lebanon's forests, gold from Ophir, and stone cut so precisely that no hammer or chisel was heard at the building site — every block arrived perfectly shaped. This was not merely architecture; it was worship expressed in stone and timber. Seven years of devoted labor, every detail planned to reflect the holiness and majesty of God. Solomon poured his wisdom into every measurement, every carving, every golden overlay.

Thousands of workers quarrying massive stone blocks, cutting cedar logs, and hauling materials. Solomon reviews architectural plans with master craftsmen. The hillside of Jerusalem buzzes with organized labor. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.

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(Zi'abeye midrawi projekit Selomon aboy Dawit ziHalemo gin kisirHo zitekelkele neger iyu neyru — nIgzi'abher Amlak Isra'el qewami bet. 'Aqenu zisdemim nebere; 30,000 seraHtenyatat ab Libanos om yiqorTsu neberu, 80,000 ab keren hager imni yiqerTsu, 70,000 Tsor yiTsewru, 3,300 Haleqatat dima neti sirah yiqoTsaTseru neberu. Selomon ninigus Hiram nay Tiros mel'ikhti sedede, "nisim Igzi'abher Amlakhey bet kisirH Hasibe alekhu" bimbāl. ZibeleTse om Libanos, werqi kab Ofir, ab bota sirHat dimTsi medosha wey sni zeytisem'alu bilik'i ziteqerTse imni — kulu blok bifiTsum qirTsu yibeTsH nebere. Izi nay hinTsa Teray ayneberen — bi'imnin 'inTseytin zitigelTse amlkho iyu neyru. Shew'ate 'ametat nay wufuy Tsa'iri, kulu zirzir nay Amlak qidsinan girman kigelTs zitemedebe. Selomon Tibebu ab kulu lik'i, kulu qirTsi, kulu nay werqi milbas afseso.)

Scene 8 of 25



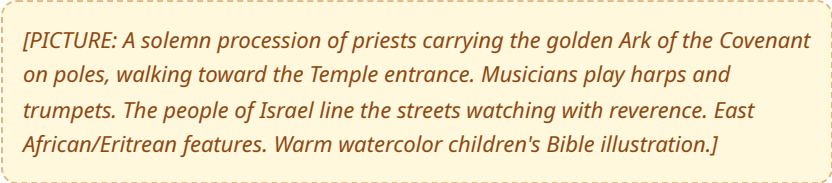
The completed Temple was unlike anything the world had ever seen. Its inner walls were overlaid with pure gold — not gilded or decorated, but covered entirely so that no stone was visible beneath. Two enormous cherubim carved from olive wood, each fifteen feet tall with wingspans of fifteen feet, stood in the Most Holy Place, their wings touching wall to wall and meeting in the center. The two great bronze pillars at the entrance — Jachin meaning "He establishes" and Boaz meaning "In Him is strength" — rose thirty feet high, topped with elaborate lily-work and pomegranates. The bronze sea, a massive basin held up by twelve bronze oxen, contained 12,000 gallons of water for priestly purification. Every surface told a story: palm trees symbolizing victory, pomegranates representing fruitfulness, lilies declaring purity. This building was theology in architecture, a physical declaration that God is holy, beautiful, and worthy of humanity's absolute best.

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(Iti zitezazeme bete meqdesi 'alem keto zeyr'ayeto nebere. WishTawi ginbotu binTsuh werqi telebisu — aytelebTsen wey aytiselemen, bimlu'u tesheflnu tiHti'u zelo imni keyr'a. Kilte 'abeyti kirubel kab 'inTseyti oliv ziteqerTsu, nefsi wekef Hamushte metro qumet Hamushte metro sijHat akhnafe zilewom, ab qidus qidusan dew ilom akhnafo kab ginbi nab ginbi tenkifom ab ma'ikel terakibom neberu. Itom kilte 'abeyti nay neHas a'inud ab me'itewi — Yakin tirigumuny "nsu yiTseni'i" Bo'az dima "ab'u Hayli alo" — 'aserte metro li'ili te'abiyu, bizitewesasebe nay shushan siraHn romann te'agibu. Iti nay neHas baHri, ab li'ili 'aserte kilte nay neHas ab'ur zitisekeme 'abiy gebeta, nikiHnet niTsihna 12,000 galon may yiHiz nebere. Kulu geTsi tarikH yinegir nebere, temri 'awet zisimbil, roman fireyamnet ziwikil, shushan niTsihna zi'iwij. Izi hinTsa ab sine-hinTsa zitigelTse sine-melekot nebere, Amlak qidus, Tsibuqn nay seb fiTsum zibeletse biqui'in mik'anu akalawi awaj.)

Scene 9 of 25



The most sacred moment arrived — the Ark of the Covenant, which had rested in a tent since the days of Moses, would finally enter its permanent home. Solomon assembled all the elders of Israel, the heads of the tribes, and the chiefs of the families. The priests carried the Ark on their shoulders with golden poles, just as God had commanded centuries before. Inside the Ark lay the two stone tablets Moses had received on Sinai — the very finger-writing of God. As the priests brought the Ark into the Most Holy Place beneath the wings of the great cherubim, the musicians and singers erupted in unified praise: 120 priests blowing trumpets in unison with singers accompanied by cymbals, harps, and lyres, all singing together, "For He is good, for His mercy endures forever." This was the culmination of generations of faithfulness — from Moses through the wilderness, through the judges, through David's wars, to this moment of peace and completion.

At this time, the Ark of the Covenant, which had been in the tent since the days of Moses, was finally brought into its permanent home. Solomon gathered all the elders of Israel, the heads of the tribes, and the chiefs of the families. The priests carried the Ark on their shoulders with golden poles, just as God had commanded centuries before. Inside the Ark were the two stone tablets that Moses had received on Sinai — the very finger-writing of God. As the priests brought the Ark into the Most Holy Place under the wings of the great cherubim, the musicians and singers broke out in unified praise: 120 priests blowing trumpets in unison with singers accompanied by cymbals, harps, and lyres, all singing together, "For He is good, for His mercy endures forever."

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*(Iti ziqedese himot beTseHe — tabot kidan, kab zemen Muse jemiru ab dinkuan
zi'arefe, ab meweda'ita nab qewami betu ki'atu nebero. Selomon nikhulom
shimagletat Isra'el, Halaqu negedatn Halaqu sidra betatn akebom. Kahnat nitabot
kemi qedem Amlak zi'azezo binay werqi meselatatat ab menkubom Tsewrwa. Ab
wishTi tabot iten Muse ab Sinay ziteqebelen kilte nay imni Tsilat — nay Amlak ba'ilu
TsiHfet aTsabi'itu — nebera. Kahnat neti tabot ab qidus qidusan tiHti akhnaf 'abeyti
kirubel kemi ze'itewwo, muziqenyatatn zemertin biHade misgana fenewu, 120 kahnat
biHade melekhet nefiHom mis TsenaTsil, mesenqon kirarn zitiseneyu zemeriti "nsu
senay iyu, miHretu nizel'alem yiTseni'i" bimbab biHade zemeru. Izi nay weledotat
mi'iman chaf nebere — kab Muse ab midre beda, ab zemen mesafinti, ab kunat
Dawit, nab izi nay selamn mizizamn himot.)*

Scene 10 of 25

[PICTURE: A thick, luminous cloud filling the interior of the Temple. Priests stumble backward, shielding their eyes, unable to stand. The golden walls glow with supernatural radiance. Solomon watches in awe from the courtyard. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Then it happened — the moment that validated everything. As the trumpeters and singers became as one to make one sound praising the Lord, a thick cloud filled the house of the Lord. The glory of God — His visible, tangible presence — descended so powerfully that the priests could not continue to minister. They stumbled out, overwhelmed, unable to stand in the weight of divine holiness. This was not a metaphor or a spiritual feeling; this was the Creator of the universe physically manifesting His presence in the building His people had made for Him. The cloud was so dense, so heavy with glory, that strong men trained for sacred service could not remain upright. God was declaring: "I accept this house. I will dwell here among my people." It was the highest affirmation Solomon would ever receive — and the standard against which all his future choices would be measured.

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(Shi'u kone — kulu ziregageTse himot. Melekheth nefeHtin zemertin kemi Hade koinom Hade dimTsi nIgzi'abher kemi zemesegenu, Tsi'uq debena bet Igzi'abher mel'a. Kibri Amlak — zir'a zidihses hilawe'u — kahnat agelgilotom kiqiTsilu zeykhiilu zikonu biHayli werede. Te'anaqifom weTsu, tese'aru, ab kibdet melekotawi qidisna dew kibilu ayke'alun. Izi misla wey menfesawi sim'it ayneberen — izi feTari 'alem abti hizbu zisirHilu hinTsa hilawe'u bi'akal zigeleTselu iyu neyru. Debena'u aziyu Tsi'uq bikibri aziyu kebid sile zinebere, nqidus agelgilot ziselTenu Hayalat seb'ut dew ilom kiTsenHu ayke'alun. Amlak yi'iwij nebere, "neza bet teqebileya alekhu. Ab ma'ikel hizbey abzi kiHadir iye." Selomon keto ziqbelo zile'ale mirigaTs nebere — kulom nay meTsa'i mirchatatu zimizenulu mesferti dima iyu neyru.)

Scene 11 of 25

[PICTURE: Solomon standing before the great bronze altar with arms spread wide toward heaven, kneeling on a bronze platform before all the assembled people of Israel. His face is lifted upward in passionate prayer. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

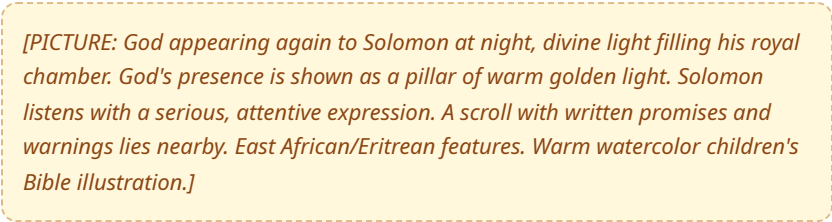
Solomon then offered one of the most beautiful prayers recorded in Scripture. Standing before the altar with hands spread toward heaven, he knelt on a bronze platform before all Israel and prayed: "Lord God of Israel, there is no God like You in heaven above or on earth below. But will God indeed dwell on the earth? Behold, heaven and the heaven of heavens cannot contain You — how much less this house I have built!" His prayer was theologically profound — acknowledging that no building could contain the infinite God, yet asking God to hear prayers directed toward this place. He prayed for the foreigner who would come to seek God, for the soldier facing battle, for the farmer needing rain, for the sinner seeking forgiveness. Solomon's prayer revealed a heart that still understood grace, still recognized human frailty, still believed in a God who hears. It was the prayer of a man at his spiritual peak — humble, wise, and deeply connected to his Creator.

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(Selomon diHri'u ab qidus TsiHuf kab zitemezgebu zitsbeqe Tselotat Hanti aqrebe. Qidmi mesew'i dew ilu a'idawu nab semay zergiHu, ab nay neHas medrekh qidmi kula Isra'el tenberikiKhu Tseleye, "O Igzi'abher Amlak Isra'el, ab semay la'ili wey ab midri taHti kemakha zibele Amlak yelen. Amlak biHaqido ab midri yiHadir? Inho semayn semay semayatn kiHzeka aykhi'iln — kindey zibeletse di'a izi ane ziseraHkuwa bet!" Tselotu sine-melekatawi 'amiq nebere — zeywisun Amlak zikone hinTsa kiHizo kemi zeykhi'il inaflete, ginakhe nabzi bota ziqen'e Tselot kismi'i Amlak lemene. Nigwana Amlak kideli zimeTse, nwig'i zigeTimu wetahader, niznab zedliyo Harestay, niyiqreta zideli HaTi'atenya Tseleye. Tselot Selomon gena Tsega zirda'e, gena dikhmet seb zileli, gena bizisemi'i Amlak zi'amin libi geleTse. Ab menfesawi chafu zinebere seb Tselot nebere — tiHut, Tibebenya, mis feTari'u bi'amiq zite'asasere.)

Scene 12 of 25



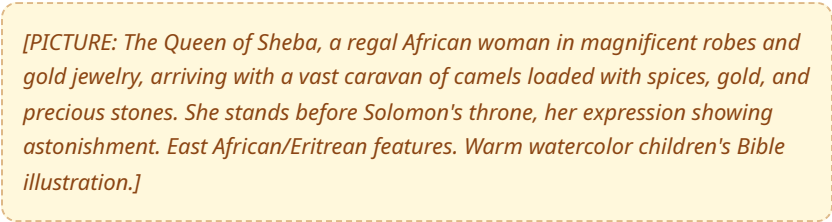
God appeared to Solomon a second time, as He had at Gibeon, and this time His words carried both promise and warning. "I have heard your prayer," God said. "I have consecrated this house which you have built, to put My name there forever; My eyes and My heart will be there perpetually." But then came the condition that would define Solomon's legacy: "If you walk before Me as your father David walked, in integrity of heart and uprightness, doing all I have commanded — then I will establish your throne over Israel forever." The warning followed like thunder after lightning: "But if you or your descendants turn away from following Me and do not keep My commandments, and go and serve other gods and worship them — then I will cut off Israel from the land I have given them, and this house I have consecrated will become a heap of ruins." God was clear: blessing is conditional upon faithfulness. The greatest temple on earth would become rubble if the hearts that built it turned away.

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(Amlak nikal'ay gize nSelomon tera'iyo, kemi ab Gib'on, Hiji gin qalattu tesfan meTenqeqtan Hizu nebere. "Tselotka semi'e alekhu" bele Amlak. "Neza zisiraHkaya bet qediseya alekhu, smey nizele'alem ab'a kigebir; a'inteyn libeyn kulu gize ab'a kikhewn iyu." Ginakhe diHri'u wirsha Selomon ziwisn qidme kunet meTse, "kemi abokha Dawit biniTsihna libin qin'inan qidmey inte temelalesKa, zi'azezkuwo kulu inte geberka — zifanka ab li'ili Isra'el nizele'alem keTzni'i iye." MeTenqeqa dima kemi negoda diHri berqi teketele, "niskha wey deqkha kab mis'abey inte temeleskum ti'izazatey zeyHalekum kal'ot amalkhti kitegeliglun kitisegdulomn inte kedkum — nIsra'el kab zihabkuwa midri kiyorTsa iye, iza ziqedesKuwa bet dima firisras kitikhewn iya." Amlak niTsur nebere, bereket ab mi'iman zitemesrete iyu. Ab midri zi'abeye bete meqdesi zihaneTswa libi inte temelsu firisras kikhewn iyu.)

Scene 13 of 25



The Queen of Sheba — a powerful ruler from a wealthy kingdom in southern Arabia or East Africa — heard of Solomon's fame and came to test him with hard questions. She arrived with a great caravan: camels bearing spices in quantities never again seen in Israel, 120 talents of gold, and precious stones beyond counting. She posed her most difficult riddles, her deepest philosophical questions, her hardest problems of governance. Solomon answered every one. "Nothing was hidden from the king which he could not explain to her." When the queen had seen Solomon's wisdom, the house he had built, the food of his table, the seating of his servants, and their magnificent clothing, she was breathless. "The half was not told me," she declared. "Your wisdom and prosperity exceed the report I heard. Happy are your servants who stand before you continually and hear your wisdom!" Even the most powerful people on earth recognized that Solomon possessed something supernatural — a divine gift that elevated him above all earthly rulers.

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(Nigiste Saba — kab habtam mengisti debub 'Areb wey mibraq Afriqa Hayal geza'it — biza'iba zina Selomon semi'a bikebedit HiTotat kitfitno meTset. Bi'abiy jeleb meTset, gemelat qimemamat diHri'u ab Isra'el keto zeytira'ie bizHi Tse'inen, 120 talent werqi, zeyquTser kibur imni. Zikebedu HiTistiTsa, zi'amequ filsifnawi HiTotata, zikebedu Tsegemat migza'e aqrebet. Selomon nikhulen melese. "Nigus kigelTsela zeykhi'il kab kabu ziteHab'e neger ayneberen." Nigisti Tibeb Selomon, zihaneTsa bet, migbi ma'idu, kof mebeli agelgeltu, kibur kidawintom mis re'ayet tinfas Tef'a. "Firqu aytinegerenn" awejet. "Tibebikayn bilTsginakhan kab zisma'ikuwo zena yi'abi. Kulu gize qidmekha ziqewmu Tibebika zismi'u agelgeltkha biTsu'an iyom!" Ab midri ziHayelu sebat'wn Selomon li'ili tefeTro zikone neger kemi zilewo tegenzibom — li'ili kulom midrawyan geza'iti zil'alo melekotawi wihbet.)

Scene 14 of 25

[PICTURE: Solomon writing by lamplight at a desk covered with scrolls. Some scrolls contain drawings of plants and animals. Musical instruments hang on the wall behind him. His face shows deep contemplation as he writes proverbs. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Solomon's intellectual output was staggering in its breadth and depth. He composed 3,000 proverbs — concentrated capsules of wisdom covering every aspect of human life: friendship, money, speech, work, marriage, parenting, anger, and the fear of the Lord. He wrote 1,005 songs, expressing the full range of human emotion through poetry and music. His Song of Songs explored the beauty and mystery of love. His Book of Proverbs became the practical handbook for living wisely. He studied and wrote about every tree, from the cedar of Lebanon to the humble hyssop; every creature that walked, flew, crawled, or swam. Solomon understood that true wisdom connects everything — that the God who made the ant also governs empires, that the principles governing a household also govern a kingdom. His mind was a gift from God, and for a season, he used it to glorify the Giver. These writings would outlast his kingdom, blessing millions across thousands of years — evidence that wisdom shared is wisdom multiplied.

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(Nay Selomon a'imroawi firyat bisifHatun 'amiqnetun zisdemim nebere. 3,000 misaletat adalewe — nay seb hiyewet kulu geTsi zishifin zite'aqebe kinin Tibeb, 'irikinet, genzeb, zereba, sirah, Hadar, ate'ababiya, quT'a, firhat Igzi'abher'n. 1,005 derfi TsaHife, bigiTimn muziqan milu'e 'awef seb'awi sim'it zigelTs. MeHalyu meHaliy Tsibaqen mistirinTiqri ases. MeTsHaf misale'u biTibeb niminbar gibrawi memriHi kone. Kab om Libanos kisab tiHut hisopos biza'iba kulu om aTsnien TseHafen; zikedy, zinefir, zilemim, ziHinbis kulu fiTur. Selomon Haqenya Tibeb kulu kemi zite'asasir teredi'u — neti Tsatse zifeTere Amlak ni'impayerat'wn kemi zigez'i, bet zigez'u metkelat nimengisti'wn kemi zigez'u. A'imro'u wihbet Amlak nebere, nigize'u dima neti wehabi ke'ikbir teTegemelu. Izi TsiHufat nimengisitu kinewHu iyom, ni'ashiHat 'ametata nimilyonat kibarkhu — zitekafele Tibeb zitebazHe Tibeb mik'anu mert'o.)

Scene 15 of 25



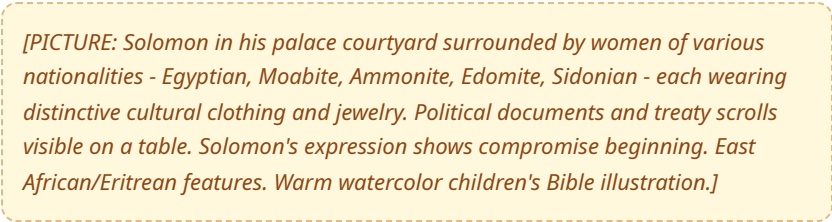
At its peak, Solomon's kingdom was the golden age Israel had always dreamed of. Silver was as common as stones in Jerusalem; cedar as plentiful as sycamore. Solomon's annual income was 666 talents of gold — not counting trade revenues and merchant tributes. His navy, built with Phoenician expertise, sailed to Tarshish bringing back gold, silver, ivory, apes, and peacocks every three years. Every king on earth sought audience with Solomon, each bringing gifts of silver, gold, garments, weapons, spices, horses, and mules. "Judah and Israel were as numerous as the sand by the sea in multitude, eating and drinking and rejoicing." Every man sat under his own vine and fig tree in peace. This was the fulfillment of God's promise to Abraham — a great nation, blessed and a blessing to others. But within this paradise, the seeds of destruction were already being planted, invisible to everyone except the God who sees hearts.

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(Ab chafu, mengisti Selomon Isra'el kulu gize ziHalemto nay werqi zemen nebere. Birur ab Iyerusalem kemi imni limud nebere; om Tsidya kemi sigminTos bizuH. 'Ametawi atawi Selomon 666 talent werqi nebere — nay nigdi atawn nay negado gibirn keyqoTserka. Bikhi'ilet Finqawiyan zitehanTse baHre serawitu nab Tershish tegu'izu ab nefsi wekef seleste 'amet werqi, birur, sni Harmaz, chegoratatn Ta'osatn yimelis nebere. Ab midri kulu nigus mis Selomon kirakeb deleye, nefsi wekef nay birur, werqi, kidawnti, aTsiwar, qimemamat, afrasn baqlan hiyabat Hizu. "Yihudan Isra'eln kemi HuTsa baHri bibizHi bizuHat, yibel'u yisetyu yiHgosu neberu." Nefsi wekef seb ab tiHti nay ri'isu weynin belesn biselam kof yibil nebere. Izi nay Amlak nAbrham zigebero tesfa fiTsame nebere — 'abiy hizbi, zitebarekhe nikhal'ot dima bereket. Ginakhe ab wishTi izi genet nay Tif'at zer'i diro yizra'e nebere, nikhulu zeyr'a bizeyika neti libi zir'i Amlak.)

Scene 16 of 25



Here begins the tragedy — not with a dramatic rebellion, but with a series of seemingly reasonable compromises. Solomon loved many foreign women: the daughter of Pharaoh, and women of the Moabites, Ammonites, Edomites, Sidonians, and Hittites — nations the Lord had specifically warned Israel against intermarrying with, "for surely they will turn away your hearts after their gods." Solomon had 700 wives of royal birth and 300 concubines. Each marriage was a political alliance, a diplomatic triumph, a guarantee of peace with a neighboring power. By worldly standards, this was brilliant statecraft. But God's command had been clear, and Solomon's wisdom should have recognized the danger. The wisest man on earth rationalized his disobedience: surely his wisdom was strong enough to resist any influence. Surely he could manage the spiritual risk. This is how every great fall begins — not with ignorance, but with arrogance disguised as confidence.

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(Abzi iti segoqa yijmir — bi'abiy 'ameTsi zeyikone biteketatelti rit'awi zimesil simimE.
 Selomon bizuHat gwanawyan ansti afqere, gwal Feri'on, Mo'abawyan, 'Amonawyan,
 Edomawyan, Sidonawyan, Hatawyanin — Igzi'abher bifluy mis'en keytimir'awu
 zi'azeze hizibttat, "birigTsi libkhum dediHri amalkhten kimelsa iyen" bimbale. Selomon
 700 nay nigusawi tiwildi anstin 300 seb Hadagin neberwo. Nefsi wekef Hadar nay
 politika kidan, nay diplomasi 'awet, mis gorebabi Hayli nay salam wiHisnet nebere.
 Bi'alemawi mesferti biluTs politika nebere. Ginakhe ti'izaz Amlak niTsur neyru, Tibebe
 Selomon'wn neti Hadega kilelyo neyrwo. Ab midri ziTebebe seb zeymi'izazu
 amekneye, birigTsi Tibebe zikone Tsilwa kiqawem zi'akil Hayal iyu. BirigTsi neti
 menfesawi Hadega kigoTsaTsero yikhi'il iyu. Kemzi iyu kulu 'abiy widqet zijmir —
 bidinkurna zeyikone bikemi imnet ziteHab'e ti'ibit.)

Scene 17 of 25

[PICTURE: An aging Solomon sitting with several of his wives in an intimate setting. One wife holds a small idol, another gestures toward a distant hilltop shrine. Solomon's face shows conflicted emotions - torn between his wives' requests and his knowledge of God's law. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

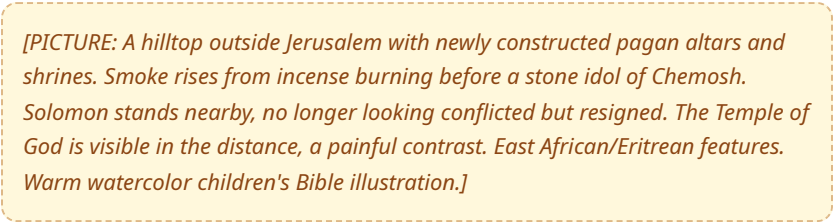
The erosion was gradual — so slow that Solomon himself may not have recognized it happening. His wives did not demand he abandon God overnight. Instead, they made small requests: "Come watch our festival." "Let me keep a small shrine in our quarters." "Surely you don't expect me to abandon my ancestors' traditions?" Each request seemed harmless in isolation. Each compromise felt reasonable. But like water wearing away stone, these small concessions gradually reshaped Solomon's heart. The text says it plainly: "When Solomon was old, his wives turned his heart after other gods, and his heart was not fully devoted to the Lord his God, as the heart of David his father had been." Not fully devoted — this is the language of divided loyalty, of a heart that tried to serve two masters. Solomon did not become an atheist; he became something more dangerous — a syncretist, mixing the worship of the true God with the worship of idols, believing he could have both.

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(Mibilshaw qes biqes nebere — Selomon ba'ilu zifiTer mik'anu keyleleye zikhede zi'akil qes biqes. Anstitu Amlak biHade leyti kiHadig ayTeleban. Ab kind'u ni'ashtu HiTotat Hateta, "nayna bi'al kitir'i ni'a." "Ab kifilna ni'ishto sifra amlkho kiHiz Hidegeni." "Nay aboHagotatey limdi kiHadig tiTsbeyeni aykonkan birigTsi?" Nefsi wekef HiTo beynu zeygode'i yimesil nebere. Nefsi wekef simimE rit'awi yisme'i nebere. Ginakhe kemi may imni zibel'i, izi ni'us mitHilafat qes biqes libi Selomon aqeyayero. TsiHuf biniTsur yibil, "Selomon mis arege anstitu libu dediHri kal'ot amalkhti melesa, libu dima kemi libi aboy Dawit nIgzi'abher Amlakhu bimlu'u wufuy ayneberen." Bimlu'u wufuy ayneberen — izi nay zitemeqle te'amannet qwanqwa iyu, nay kilte goyitot kegeligil zifetene libi. Selomon Amlak yelen zibil aykonen — zikef'e zikone neger kone — amlkho Haqenya Amlak mis amlkho Ta'otat ziHawawese, kilti'u kihliwo kemi zikhiil zi'amene.)

Scene 18 of 25



The man who had built the most glorious house for God now built shrines to false gods on the hills surrounding Jerusalem. Solomon built a high place for Chemosh, the abomination of Moab — a god whose worship included child sacrifice — on the hill east of Jerusalem. He did the same for Molech, the detestable god of the Ammonites, whose bronze statue consumed children in fire. He built places of worship for Ashtoreth, goddess of the Sidonians, associated with temple prostitution and fertility rites. The same hands that had designed God's Temple now designed altars to demons. The same mind that had written "The fear of the Lord is the beginning of wisdom" now calculated the dimensions of pagan shrines. This is the horror of compromise: it doesn't just weaken your faith — it weaponizes your gifts against the God who gave them. Solomon's wisdom, meant to glorify God, was now being used to efficiently organize idolatry.

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(Iti nAmlak zikebere bet zihaneTse seb Hiji ab akhranat Iyerusalem niHasewti amalkhti meqdesat haneTse. Selomon niKemosh — Tsiyaf Mo'ab — amlkho'u nay qol'u meswa'iti ziHaqofe Amlak — ab mibraq Iyerusalem zelo akhran berikH bota haneTse. NiMolekh nay 'Amonawyan ziTsiyef Amlak — nay neHas mislu qol'u biHawi zibel'i nebere — kem'u gebere. Ni'ashtoret Amlak Sidonawyan — mis nay bete meqdesi amenzranet'n nay fireyamnet sir'at'n zite'asasere — bota amlkho haneTse. Bete meqdesi Amlak zinedefe a'idaw Hiji ni'aganninti mesew'i yinedfiu neberu. "Firhat Igzi'abher mejemerta Tibeb iyu" ziTseHafe a'imro Hiji nay Ta'ot meqdesat lik'i yiqemir nebere. Izi nay simimE seqoqa iyu, ab imnetka midkham Teray aykonenn — wihbetka anTsar iti zihabeka Amlak kemi aTsiwar yigebro. Tibeb Selomon Amlak ke'ikbir ziteHasbe Hiji Ta'ot amlkho bibqi'at kimiHadir yiTeqimelu nebere.)

Scene 19 of 25

[PICTURE: A divine light breaking through storm clouds above Solomon's palace. Solomon looks up with a stricken, guilty expression. The image conveys God's righteous anger mixed with grief over a beloved child who has strayed. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

The Lord became angry with Solomon — not with the cold anger of an offended ruler, but with the burning grief of a betrayed lover. God had appeared to Solomon twice. He had given him everything. He had specifically warned him about this exact danger. "The Lord said to Solomon, 'Since this is your attitude and you have not kept my covenant and my decrees which I commanded you, I will surely tear the kingdom away from you and give it to one of your servants.'" Yet even in judgment, God's mercy appeared: "Nevertheless, I will not do it during your lifetime, for the sake of David your father. I will tear it out of the hand of your son. Yet I will not tear away the whole kingdom; I will give your son one tribe, for the sake of David my servant and for the sake of Jerusalem, which I have chosen." God's discipline is always measured, always remembering His promises, always balancing justice with mercy. But the consequence was irreversible — what Solomon had built would crumble because of what Solomon had become.

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(Igzi'abher ab Selomon teqoTi'e — bizibedelo geza'i ziHul quT'a zeyikone biziteTeelme fetawi zinedid Hazen. Amlak nSelomon kilte gize tera'iyu neyru. Kulu hibwo neyru. Bifluy biza'iba izi liki'i Hadega aTenqiqwo neyru. "Igzi'abher nSelomon 'izi are'a'iyakha sile zikone kidaneyn Higagateyn zi'azezkukha zeyHalewka, birigTsi neti mengisti kabakha kiqeddo nHade kab agelgeltkha kihbo iye' belo." Ginakhe ab firdi'wn miHret Amlak tera'ie, "yikun'mber bihiywetka aygebron, mi'inti abokha Dawit. Kab id wedkha kiqeddo iye. Ginakhe kula mengisti ayqedidn — niwedkha Hade neged kihbo iye, mi'inti baryay Dawitin mi'inti zimireTskuwa Iyerusalemin." TegisaTsi Amlak kulu gize zitemeTene, kulu gize tesfatatu zizikir, kulu gize fitHin miHretin zimiazazin iyu. Ginakhe sa'iben zeymiles nebere — Selomon zihaneTso kiferis nebero mikinyatu Selomon zikono sile ziteqeyere.)

Scene 20 of 25

[PICTURE: The prophet Ahijah meeting Jeroboam on a deserted road. Ahijah tears his new garment into twelve pieces, offering ten pieces to the young, strong-looking Jeroboam. The scene conveys prophetic authority and divine decision. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

God raised up adversaries against Solomon, and among them was a servant named Jeroboam, a capable young man whom Solomon had appointed over the labor force of the house of Joseph. One day, the prophet Ahijah met Jeroboam on the road outside Jerusalem. Ahijah was wearing a new garment, and he seized it and tore it into twelve pieces. "Take for yourself ten pieces," the prophet said, "for thus says the Lord: 'Behold, I will tear the kingdom out of the hand of Solomon and give you ten tribes — but he shall have one tribe, for the sake of My servant David and for the sake of Jerusalem.'"

This dramatic prophetic act declared that Solomon's unfaithfulness would fracture the nation his father had unified through decades of war. The kingdom built on wisdom would be divided by folly. When Solomon heard about this prophecy, he tried to kill Jeroboam — the wisest king resorting to murder to preserve what only faithfulness could have maintained. Jeroboam fled to Egypt until Solomon's death.

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(Amlak ab li'ili Selomon teTsaba'iti atenis'a, ab ma'ikelom dima Yerob'am zisimu agelgali — Selomon ab li'ili gulbet bet Yosef zishemo biqu'i men'esey — nebere. Hade me'alti nebiy AHiya ab weTsa'i Iyerusalem ab mengedi niYerob'am rekebo. AHiya Hadish kidan tekhedinu nebere, Hizwo bi'aserte kilte quraTsi qededdo. "Nri'iskha 'aserte quraTsi wised" bele nebiy, "kemey Igzi'abher kemzi yibil, 'inho neti mengisti kab id Selomon kiqedid 'aserte neged kihbeka iye — nsu gin Hade neged kihlwo iyu, mi'inti baryay Dawitin mi'inti Iyerusalemin.'" Izi dramawi nay nebiy tegbar zeymi'iman Selomon neti aboy bi'asertettat 'ametad kunat zisenakelo hizbi kemi zisebir aweje. Ab Tibeb zitihanTse mengisti bi'ishnet kimiqel nebero. Selomon biza'iba izi tinbit mis semi'e niYerob'am kiquetlo fetene — iti ziTebebe nigus mi'iman Teray kiHilwo zikhiil zinebere neger nimiHlaw nab qitlet yiTeqim. Yerob'am kisab mot Selomon nab GibTsi hademe.)

Scene 21 of 25

[PICTURE: An elderly, weary Solomon sitting alone in a lavish but empty room, writing on a scroll by dim candlelight. His expression shows deep regret and world-weariness. Luxurious objects surround him but bring no joy. The word "Hevel" (vanity) is visible on the scroll. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

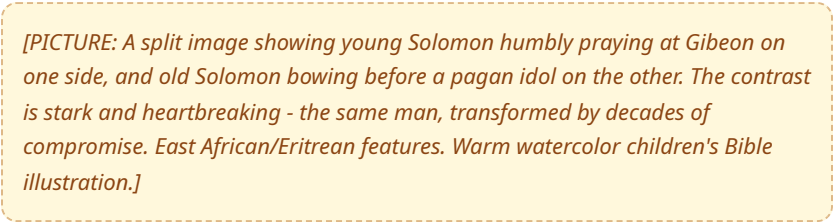
In his later years, Solomon wrote what many scholars believe to be the Book of Ecclesiastes — a brutally honest reflection on a life lived with every advantage yet ending in emptiness. "Vanity of vanities," he wrote, "all is vanity." The word in Hebrew is "hevel" — meaning breath, mist, something that appears substantial but dissolves when grasped. He who had tasted every pleasure wrote: "I said to myself, come now, I will test you with pleasure — and behold, it too was vanity." He who possessed unmatched wisdom wrote: "For in much wisdom is much grief, and increasing knowledge increases sorrow." He who owned everything wrote: "Then I looked on all that my hands had done, and behold, all was vanity and striving after wind." This was not nihilism — it was the confession of a man who had learned the hardest lesson too late: that everything apart from God is ultimately meaningless, no matter how golden it appears.

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*(Ab diHreway 'ametattu Selomon bizuHat mihurat zi'aminwo meTsHaf Mekbib
 TseHafe — bikulu Tsega zitrinebere gin bibadonet zitezazeme hiyewet bichibiTi
 zitegi hade mistinitan. "Kentu kenatu" TseHafe "kulu kentu iyu." Iti qal bi'ibraysT
 "hevel" — tinfas, gag, mis Hazkayo zibennin teba'i zimesil neger malet iyu. Kulu desta
 ziTe'ame TseHafe, "nri'isey belku ane diHri Hiji bidesta kifitneka — inho nsu'wn kentu
 iyu nebere." Zeytiwadadir Tibe zinebero TseHafe, "ab bizuH Tibe bizuH Hazen alo,
 filiTet miwsakh dima gwahi yiwsikH." Kulu zinebero TseHafe, "diHri'u a'idawey
 zisirHe'o kulu Temetku, inho kulu kentun nifas mis'abin nebere." Izi nihilizm
 ayneberen — biTa'imi kebid timhirti denguyu zitimehare seb nay imnet awaj nebere,
 kab Amlak weTsa'i kulu neger ab mewedat'ita tirigum zeybilu mik'anu, kindey nay
 werqi yimesil bizeyigedis.)*

Scene 22 of 25



Consider the tragic contrast that defines Solomon's story. The young man who humbly said "I am but a little child" became the old king who arrogantly believed he could manage sin. The king who asked for wisdom to serve others used that wisdom to accumulate 700 wives for himself. The builder of God's Temple became the builder of pagan shrines. The writer of "Trust in the Lord with all your heart and lean not on your own understanding" ultimately leaned entirely on his own understanding. Solomon proves a disturbing truth: intelligence is not immunity from deception. Gifting does not guarantee faithfulness. Starting well does not ensure finishing well. The wisest person who ever lived made the most foolish choice possible — trading the living God for dead idols. His story is not a cautionary tale for the simple-minded; it is a warning for the brilliant, the gifted, the successful — those most likely to believe they are above temptation.

Consider the tragic contrast that defines Solomon's story. The young man who humbly said "I am but a little child" became the old king who arrogantly believed he could manage sin. The king who asked for wisdom to serve others used that wisdom to accumulate 700 wives for himself. The builder of God's Temple became the builder of pagan shrines. The writer of "Trust in the Lord with all your heart and lean not on your own understanding" ultimately leaned entirely on his own understanding. Solomon proves a disturbing truth: intelligence is not immunity from deception. Gifting does not guarantee faithfulness. Starting well does not ensure finishing well. The wisest person who ever lived made the most foolish choice possible — trading the living God for dead idols. His story is not a cautionary tale for the simple-minded; it is a warning for the brilliant, the gifted, the successful — those most likely to believe they are above temptation.

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(Zanta Selomon ziwisn seqoqawi niTsiTsir Hiseb. "Ane ni'ishto qol'a Teray iye" bitiHtina
 zibele men'eseY HaTi'at kiqoTsaTser kemi zikhiil bi'ibit zi'amene aregit nigus kone.
 Nikhal'ot kegeligil Tibeb ziHatete nigus neta Tibeb 700 ansti nri'isu ki'ikib teTeqemela.
 Nay Amlak bete meqdesi hanaTsi nay Ta'ot meqdesat hanaTsi kone. "Bikulu libkha ab
 Igzi'abher te'amen ab nay ri'iskha a'imro dima aytiTsega'i" ziTseHafe ab meweda'ita
 ab nay ri'isu a'imro bimlu'u teTsegi'e. Selomon zishegir Haqi yiregagTs, bilHat kab
 midinigar mikilikhal aykonenn. Wihbet mi'imman ayewiHsin. Tsibuq mijmar Tsibuq
 mizizam ayeregagTsin. Zinebere ziTebebe seb ziki'al zi'ishew mircha gebere — hiyaw
 Amlak bimwitat Ta'otat qeyero. Zant'u niqeletti sebat zikone nay Tinqaqe zanta
 aykonenn — nibluTsat, wihbu, 'iwutat — kab fetena li'ili mik'anom zi'aminu nizibelu
 zikone meTenqeqa iyu.)

Scene 23 of 25

[PICTURE: Solomon's funeral procession through Jerusalem, followed by a scene of his son Rehoboam on the throne with angry crowds before him. The kingdom splits - a map showing Israel in the north and Judah in the south. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Solomon reigned for forty years, then died and was buried in the City of David. His son Rehoboam inherited the throne but not his father's wisdom. When the people asked Rehoboam to lighten the heavy labor his father had imposed, the young king foolishly threatened to make it worse. "My father disciplined you with whips; I will discipline you with scorpions." The ten northern tribes immediately revolted under Jeroboam, exactly as the prophet Ahijah had foretold. The united kingdom of Israel — built through the blood of David and the wisdom of Solomon — shattered like a clay pot dropped on stone. It would never be reunited. Two kingdoms now existed where one had stood: Israel in the north, Judah in the south. Solomon's legacy was not the wisdom he'd been given or the temple he'd built, but the division his unfaithfulness caused. The consequences of his compromise would echo through centuries of civil war, idolatry, and eventually exile.

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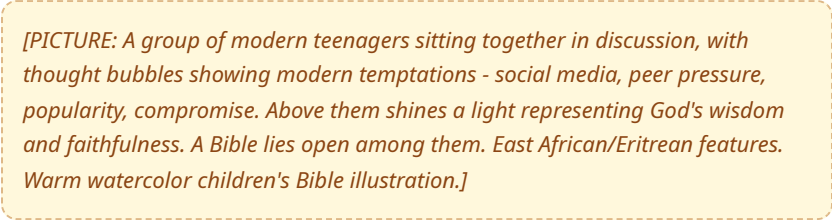
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(Selomon arbi'a 'amet geziu mote ab ketema Dawit dima tegebre. Wedu Rob'am zifan werese ginakhe Tibeb aboy ayweresen. Hizbi niRob'am aboy ziTse'ano kebid gulbet keqilil mis Hateto, iti men'esey nigus bi'ishnet kigadido aferarhe. "Aboy biHalengi qeTsi'ukum — ane bi'inqurbit kiqeTsi'akum iye." 'Aserte semenawyan negedat bi'u nib'u tiHti Yerob'am 'ameTsu, lik'i kemi nebiy AHiya zitenebeyo. Nay milu'e Isra'el Hibur mengisti — bideṁ Dawitin Tibeb Solomonin zitiḥanTse — kemi ab imni ziṽdeqe nay shekhli 'itro tisebre. Keto dagmay ayHibernn nebere. Hade ziqewmelu kilte mengisti Hiji nebere, Isra'el ab semen, Yihuda ab debub. Wirsha Selomon zitewahabo Tibeb wey zihaneTso bete meqdesi ayneberen, zeymi'imānu zis'abo mikifilal de'a. Nay simim'u sa'ibenat ab zemenat nay HidiHid kunat, Ta'ot amlkhon ab meweda'ita sidetin kidwen nebēro.)

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(Kab ziskahikiH widqet Selomon intay kinimehar nikhiil? Qedamay, zeytiHalewe libi zikone 'aqen filiTet kemi zeykelakhelo. Selomon ti'azazat Amlak bifiTsum yifeliTom nebere — bizuHat nikhal'ot TsiHifwom. Ginakhe Haqi miflaTin Haqi minbarin biTa'imi zitefelaleye iyu. Kal'ay, simimE keto ni'ishto koynu kemi zeyTsenH. Qedamay politikawi Hadar Selomon zeygode'i yimesil nebere — Hade kidan, Hanti sebeyti, ab chaf mengisti ziteTsewere Hade ni'ishto meqdesi. Ginakhe simimE nab dur zi'abi zer'i iyu. Salisay, zi'abeye Hayilna bizuH gize zi'abeye dikhmetna yikhewn. Tibeb Selomon zikone kiqoTsaTser kemi zikhiil ate'amaiminu, iti lik'i imnet dima zeyteTenqege gebero. Rab'ay, meTenqeeta Amlak ri'ito aykonenn. Amlak "aytimara'awu" mis bele zeyrit'awi wey seb zi'qoTsaTser ayneberen — nSelomon ab meweda'ita kab zibel'o lik'i Tif'at yikelakhelo nebere. Selomon ba'ilu ziTseHafo misale tinbitawi kone, "li'ili kulu libkha Halu, kemey kulu zigebro kab'u yiwHiz.")

Scene 25 of 25



Solomon's story speaks directly to you — especially if you are young, gifted, and full of potential. The world will offer you the same bargain it offered Solomon: compromise just a little, and you can have success, popularity, relationships, and comfort. It will seem reasonable. It will feel manageable. But every great fall begins with a small step in the wrong direction. You don't have to be foolish to fall — you just have to be careless. Wisdom without faithfulness is like a sword without a hand to wield it — impressive but useless. God offers you something Solomon had but eventually squandered: a relationship where you are known, guided, protected, and loved. Guard that relationship above everything else. Don't trade eternal treasure for temporary pleasure. Don't let the gradual erosion of small compromises reshape your heart without you noticing. Be wiser than Solomon — not by being smarter, but by being more faithful. For at the end of Ecclesiastes, after all his searching, Solomon finally concluded: "Fear God and keep His commandments, for this is the whole duty of man."

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(Zanta Selomon biqeTta ni'akha yizareb — biflay men'esey, wihib, bi'iquba zimel'e
 inte konka. 'Alem nSelomon zihabeto lik'i simimE kihbeka iya, qirub Teray tetaHaHaz
 'awet, teflaTnet, rikib, michot kihlweka yikhiil iyu. Rit'awi kimesil iyu. KiqoTsaTsero
 zike'al kismi'aka iyu. Ginakhe kulu 'abiy widqet bini'ishto sigumti nab gega anifet
 yijmir. Kitiwediq 'ishuw kitikhewn ayedliyekan — zeytiTenqege mik'an Teray yi'akil.
 Tibeb bizey mi'iman kemi zichibiTo id zeybilu sef iyu — zidenq gin zeyTeqim. Amlak
 Selomon zinebero gin ab meweda'ita zibakheno neger yihbeka, tifleT, timraH, tiHilo,
 tifiqer ziLekhalu rikib. Nezi rikib li'ili kulu Halu. Zel'alemawi habti bigizeyawi desta
 aytiqeyir. Qes biqes mibilshaw nay ni'us simimE keyistew'alka libkha keyqiyir
 aytifeqid. Kab Selomon ziyada Tibebenya kun — biziyada bilHi zeyikone biziyada
 mi'iman. Kemey ab meweda'ita Mekbib diHri kulu midlayu Selomon ab meweda'ita
 demdeme, "nAmlak firaH ti'azazatu dima Halu, kemey nay seb milu'e Halafinet izi
 iyu.")

The Moral of the Story

Even the greatest gifts from God — wisdom, talent, intelligence, opportunity — can be wasted and weaponized through unfaithfulness and compromise. Solomon received more from God than any person in history, yet his story ends in tragedy because he failed to guard his heart. Knowledge of truth does not protect us; only faithful obedience to truth protects us. Small compromises, left unchecked, grow into devastating consequences that affect not just us but everyone connected to us.

Key Verse: "Above all else, guard your heart, for everything you do flows from it." — Proverbs 4:23

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(Li'ili kulu libkha Halu, kemey kulu zigebro kab'u yiwHiz. — Misale 4:23)

Wisdom without faithfulness is a ship without an anchor — impressive in calm seas, but destined to crash when storms come. Be wiser than Solomon: guard your heart above all else.

Discussion Questions

1. The Anatomy of Compromise: Solomon's fall didn't happen overnight — it was a gradual process of small concessions. Can you identify areas in your own life where you might be making "small compromises" that could grow into something bigger? What makes compromise so dangerous — is it the individual act, or the pattern it creates?

2. Wisdom vs. Faithfulness: Solomon had more wisdom than anyone who ever lived, yet he still fell. What does this tell us about the relationship between knowing what is right and actually doing what is right? Why is faithfulness more important than intelligence when it comes to living well?

3. The Influence of Relationships: Solomon's wives "turned his heart." How do the people closest to us shape our values and decisions, often without us realizing it? How can you evaluate whether your closest relationships are pulling you toward God or away from Him — and what should you do if they're pulling you away?

4. Gifting and Vulnerability: Solomon's greatest strength (wisdom) became his greatest weakness (overconfidence). What are your greatest gifts or strengths, and how might they become points of vulnerability? How can you stay humble about your abilities while still using them fully?

5. Guarding Your Heart in the Modern World: Proverbs 4:23 says to guard your heart "above all else." In a world of social media, peer pressure, and constant exposure to competing values, what does it practically look like for a teenager to guard their heart? What

specific strategies can you put in place to protect yourself from the gradual drift Solomon experienced?

A Prayer for Wisdom and Faithfulness

Heavenly Father, we come before You humbled by the story of Solomon — a man who had everything yet lost what mattered most. We ask You for wisdom, Lord, but even more than wisdom, we ask for faithfulness. Give us hearts that stay true to You, even when compromise seems reasonable and harmless.

We confess that we are vulnerable. We are not above temptation. We cannot manage sin on our own. We need Your Holy Spirit to guard our hearts when our own strength fails. Help us to recognize small compromises before they become great failures. Give us the courage to say no when the world says yes, and to stand firm when everyone around us is drifting.

Lord, let us learn from Solomon's tragedy so we do not repeat it. May we be people who not only know Your truth but live it faithfully every day. May our gifts glorify You rather than serve our own pride. And when we stumble — because we will — may we run back to You rather than further away.

Above all else, help us guard our hearts. For everything we do flows from them. In Jesus' name we pray, Amen.

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(Ab li'ili kulu libna niHalu, kemey kulu zingebro kab'u yiwHiz.)

Little Believers Tigrinya Bible Stories

Written by Daniel Tesfamariam

Contact: dannyshalom.etsy.com

Email: Dannyshalomnebiy@gmail.com

WhatsApp: +971525950021

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